

Early Rehabilitation Assessment and Referral Protocol for Stroke Patients

Stroke Program - Rehabilitation Services

Purpose

To ensure all stroke patients receive early rehabilitation screening and referral within 24 hours of admission.

Responsible Team

Stroke Physician

Nurse

Physical Therapy (PT)

Occupational Therapy (OT)

Speech-Language Pathology (SLP)

Timeline

Time	Action	Responsible
ED arrival	Initial mobility and swallow screening	Nurse
Within 24 hours	PT assessment	PT
Within 24 hours	OT assessment	OT
Within 24 hours	Speech / swallow assessment	SLP
Daily	Multidisciplinary rehabilitation rounds	Stroke Team
Before discharge	Rehabilitation plan finalized	MDT

Referral Criteria

Rehabilitation referral applies to patients presenting with any of the following:

All ischemic stroke

Intracerebral hemorrhage

TIA with functional deficit

Dysphagia

Aphasia

Mobility impairment

ADL (activities of daily living) impairment

Assessment Tools

NIHSS (National Institutes of Health Stroke Scale)

Modified Rankin Scale (mRS)

Barthel Index

Functional Independence Measure (optional)

Required Documentation

PT Evaluation Form

OT Evaluation Form

SLP Evaluation Form

Rehabilitation Care Plan